UP-PCS PRELIMS 2026 Â· HIGH PROBABILITY QUESTION BANK

Master Expected Questions — Part 4

High-Yield Questions 226 to 300 (Random Subject Distribution with UPPSC Traps & Ratta Points)

QUESTION RANGE
Questions 226 – 300

PATTERN & STYLE
UPPSC 2024â€"2025 Standard (Statements, A&R, Match Lists)

STUDY FORMAT
Question â†' Options â†' Answer â†' In-Depth Ratta & Trap Notes

TARGET DATE
December 6 Prelims Examination

UPPCS Prelims 2026 Expected Questions — Part 4 (Q226 to Q300)

Subject Distribution: Randomized Full-Spectrum GS (History, Geography, Polity, Science, Environment, Economy, UP Special, Current Affairs)
Exam Standard: Multi-statement, Assertion-Reason, Match Lists & Direct Factual Traps as per UPPSC 2024–2025 Trends

Question 226

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Right to Equality (Articles 14 to 18)

Match List-I (Article of the Constitution) with List-II (Specific Fundamental Right) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Article) A. Article 14
B. Article 15
C. Article 16
D. Article 17

List-II (Specific Right) 1. Equality of opportunity in matters of public employment
2. Equality before the law and equal protection of the laws
3. Abolition of Untouchability and prohibition of its practice in any form
4. Prohibition of discrimination on grounds only of religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Article 14:** Two concepts: "Equality before law" (negative concept borrowed from British common law) and "Equal protection of laws" (positive concept borrowed from the American Constitution). - **Article 15:** Prohibits discrimination on five grounds ONLY: religion, race, caste, sex, place of birth. - **Article 16:** Equality of opportunity in public employment (grounds: religion, race, caste, sex, descent, place of birth, residence). - **Article 17:** Absolute right; abolishes Untouchability; enforced via Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955. - **Article 18:** Abolishes titles (except military and academic distinctions). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Articles available ONLY to Indian citizens: **Articles 15, 16, 19, 29, and 30**! All other Fundamental Rights (including Articles 14, 20, 21, 21A, 22, 25-28) apply to all persons (both citizens and foreigners).

Question 227

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Passes of the Western Ghats (Sahyadri)

Match List-I (Mountain Pass in Western Ghats) with List-II (Route / Cities Connected) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Pass) A. Thalghat (Kasara Ghat)
B. Bhorghat (Khandala Ghat)
C. Palghat Gap (Palakkad)
D. Shencottah Gap

List-II (Cities Connected) 1. Connects Mumbai with Pune and further to Chennai / Bengaluru
2. Connects Mumbai with Nashik and further to Kolkata / Northern India
3. Connects Madurai (Tamil Nadu) with Kollam (Kerala)
4. Connects Palakkad / Kochi (Kerala) with Coimbatore (Tamil Nadu) between Nilgiri and Anaimalai hills

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Thalghat:** Located in Maharashtra; carries the NH-3 and central railway connecting **Mumbai with Nashik** and northern/eastern India. - **Bhorghat:** Located in Maharashtra; carries the Mumbai-Pune Expressway connecting **Mumbai with Pune** and southern India. - **Palghat Gap:** Natural 30 km wide gap in Western Ghats between **Nilgiri Hills to the north and Anaimalai Hills to the south**; connects Coimbatore (TN) with Palakkad (Kerala). - **Shencottah Gap:** Located between Cardamom

hills and Agasthyamalai hills; connects **Kollam (Kerala) with Madurai (TN)**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Sequence from North to South in Western Ghats: **Thalghat -> Bhorghat -> Palghat -> Shencottah**!

Question 228

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Later Vedic Rituals and Sacrifices

Match List-I (Vedic Sacrifice / Ritual) with List-II (Significance / Nature) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Sacrifice) A. Rajasuya Yajna
B. Ashvamedha Yajna
C. Vajapeya Yajna
D. Agnistoma Yajna

List-II (Significance) 1. Chariot race in which the royal chariot was made to win; drink of soma; rejuvenated king's vitality
2. Consecration ceremony to bestow supreme sovereign power upon the king; involved ratnin offerings
3. Horse sacrifice to assert imperial territorial supremacy over neighboring realms
4. Extensive sacrifice involving animal offering to Agni and pressing of Soma juice lasting for days

Options: A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
C. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
D. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Rajasuya:** Royal consecration ritual; king visited homes of 12 *Ratnins* (jewels/officers) to secure their loyalty; included a game of dice. - **Ashvamedha:** King let loose a consecrated royal stallion to wander for a year; any king who stopped it had to battle the imperial army; concluded with sacrifice of the horse. - **Vajapeya ("Drink of Strength"):** Chariot race staged so the king won against competitors, renewing his vigor. - **Agnistoma:** Dedicated to Agni and Indra; accompanied by chanting of Sama hymns and consumption of Soma. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Pushyamitra Shunga performed **two Ashvamedha Yajnas** at Ayodhya, recorded in the Ayodhya inscription of Dhanadeva!

Question 229

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Endocrine Disorders in Humans

Match List-I (Endocrine Disorder) with List-II (Hormonal Cause) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Disorder) A. Diabetes Mellitus
B. Diabetes Insipidus
C. Addison's Disease
D. Cushing's Syndrome

List-II (Hormonal Cause) 1. Hyposecretion of Antidiuretic Hormone (ADH / Vasopressin) from posterior pituitary
2. Deficiency of Insulin secretion from beta-cells of pancreas (hyperglycemia)
3. Hypersecretion of Cortisol (glucocorticoids) from adrenal cortex
4. Hyposecretion of Corticoid hormones (cortisol & aldosterone) from adrenal cortex

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Diabetes Mellitus:** Caused by insulin deficiency or receptor insensitivity; high blood glucose; glucose appears in urine (*Glycosuria*). - **Diabetes Insipidus:** Caused by ADH (Vasopressin) deficiency; distal tubules fail to reabsorb water; massive water loss in urine (*Polyuria*) without glucose! - **Addison's Disease:** Adrenal cortical insufficiency; bronze pigmentation of skin, low blood pressure, severe fatigue, hypoglycemia. - **Cushing's Syndrome:** Excess cortisol secretion; characterized by "Moon face", "Buffalo hump", obesity, and high blood pressure. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Diabetes *Insipidus* involves WATER balance (ADH deficiency); urine is tasteless (*insipid*) with NO sugar. Diabetes *Mellitus* involves SUGAR balance (Insulin deficiency); urine is sweet (*mellitus* = honey)!

Question 230

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Religious Fairs and Pilgrimage Sites in UP

Match List-I (Fair / Festival in UP) with List-II (District / Shrine) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Fair) A. Deva Sharif Fair
B. Kampil Fair
C. Bateshwar Fair
D. Magh Mela

List-II (District / Shrine) 1. Agra; annual animal fair on Yamuna river
2. Barabanki; shrine of Sufi saint Waris Ali Shah
3. Prayagraj; annual holy bathing festival at Triveni Sangam
4. Farrukhabad; Jain fair held at the ancient capital of South Panchala

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Deva Sharif (Barabanki):** Annual fair held at the Dargah of revered Sufi saint Haji Waris Ali Shah; symbol of Hindu-Muslim unity (held during Karwa Chauth / October–November). - **Kampil Fair (Farrukhabad):** Held at Kampilya (historic capital of Panchala Mahajanapada); sacred Jain pilgrimage site (birthplace of 13th Tirthankara Vimalanatha). - **Bateshwar Fair (Agra):** Famous Shiva temple complex with 101 temples and immense cattle/camel mela. - **Magh Mela (Prayagraj):** Annual festival held in the Hindu month of Magh at Triveni Sangam (Kumbh occurs every 12 years; Maha Kumbh held in Prayagraj). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Deva Sharif is in **Barabanki**; Syed Salar Masud Ghazi Dargah is in **Bahraich**!

Question 231

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Famous Tiger Reserves of India

Match List-I (Tiger Reserve) with List-II (State) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Tiger Reserve) A. Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve
B. Nagarhole (Rajiv Gandhi) Tiger Reserve
C. Ranthambore Tiger Reserve
D. Valmiki Tiger Reserve

List-II (State) 1. Karnataka
2. Madhya Pradesh
3. Bihar
4. Rajasthan

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bandhavgarh (MP):** Highest tiger density in India; former hunting preserve of Maharaja of Rewa; white tigers originated here. - **Nagarhole (Karnataka):** Part of Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve; located on Kabini river basin. - **Ranthambore (Rajasthan):** Famous for tigers thriving around historical 10th-century Ranthambore Fort. - **Valmiki (West Champaran, Bihar):** The ONLY Tiger Reserve and National Park in the state of Bihar (contiguous with Nepal's Chitwan National Park). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Pakke Tiger Reserve and Namdapha are in **Arunachal Pradesh**; Dampa is in **Mizoram**; Similipal is in **Odisha**; Melghat and Tadoba-Andhari are in **Maharashtra**!

Question 232

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Money Market Instruments

Consider the following statements regarding Treasury Bills (T-Bills) in India: 1. Treasury Bills are zero-coupon debt instruments issued by the Government of India to meet short-term liquidity mismatches. 2. They are issued at a discount to face value and redeemed at par on

maturity. 3. Treasury Bills are currently issued in three tenors: 91-day, 182-day, and 364-day. 4. State Governments in India also issue their own Treasury Bills to raise short-term finance.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 3 and 4 only
C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1, 2, and 3 are correct: T-Bills are short-term sovereign money market instruments auctioned by the RBI; issued at discount and redeemed at par (the difference is the interest yield). Active tenors are 91 days, 182 days, and 364 days. - Statement 4 is incorrect: **State Governments DO NOT issue Treasury Bills!** Only the Central Government issues T-Bills. State Governments issue State Development Loans (SDLs) and obtain short-term advances via Ways and Means Advances (WMA) from the RBI. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Massive UPPSC trap: Treasury Bills are issued EXCLUSIVELY by the Central Government, NEVER by State Governments!

Question 233

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Cinema & 77th Cannes Film Festival 2024

Consider the following statements regarding the 77th Cannes Film Festival held in May 2024: 1. Indian filmmaker Payal Kapadia's film *All We Imagine as Light* won the prestigious Grand Prix (the festival's second-highest award). 2. It was the first Indian film in 30 years to compete in the main Competition section at Cannes. 3. Indian actress Anasuya Sengupta won the Best Actress award in the 'Un Certain Regard' category for her performance in *The Shameless*.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Payal Kapadia:** Her Malayalam-Hindi feature *All We Imagine as Light* won the prestigious **Grand Prix** at Cannes 2024 (the Palme d'Or was won by American director Sean Baker's *Anora*). It was the first Indian film in official competition since Shaji N. Karun's *Swaham* in 1994. - **Anasuya Sengupta:** Became the **first Indian artist** to win the Best Actress award at Cannes (in the 'Un Certain Regard' section). - Chidananda S. Naik's FTII student film *Sunflowers Were the First Ones to Know* won first prize in the La Cinef section. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Chetan Anand's *Neecha Nagar* remains the only Indian film ever to win the top prize (Palme d'Or / Grand Prix du Festival) at Cannes in 1946!

Question 234

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Chroniclers and Literary Sources of the Sultanate

Match List-I (Medieval Text) with List-II (Chronicler / Author) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Text) A. Tabaqat-i-Nasiri
B. Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi
C. Futuh-us-Salatin
D. Kitab-ur-Rihla

List-II (Author) 1. Ziauddin Barani (and later completed by Shams-i-Siraj Afif)
2. Minhaj-i-Siraj Juzjani
3. Ibn Battuta
4. Abdul Malik Isami

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri:** Written in Persian by **Minhaj-i-Siraj**; dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud; primary source for the early Slave dynasty and Muhammad Ghori's campaigns. - **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi:** Written by **Ziauddin Barani**; chronicles the Sultanate from Balban's accession up to the 6th year of Firoz Shah Tughlaq's reign (Barani also wrote *Fatawa-i-Jahandari* on political theory). - **Futuh-us-Salatin:** Written in verse by **Isami**; dedicated to Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah (founder of the Bahmani kingdom). - **Rihla:** Celebrated travelogue written in Arabic by Moroccan traveler **Ibn Battuta**, chronicling the 14 years he spent in India during Muhammad bin Tughlaq's reign. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** *Khazain-ul-Futuh* (describing Alauddin Khalji's conquests) and *Tughlaqnama* were written by **Amir Khusrau**!

Question 235

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Famous Straits of Europe & the Americas

Match List-I (Strait) with List-II (Geographical Separation / Water Bodies Connected) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Strait) A. Bosporus Strait
B. Dardanelles Strait
C. Strait of Messina
D. Cook Strait

List-II (Connected / Separated) 1. Separates North Island and South Island of New Zealand
2. Connects Black Sea with Sea of Marmara (separates European and Asian Istanbul)
3. Separates the island of Sicily from mainland Italy (Calabria)
4. Connects Sea of Marmara with Aegean Sea

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1
B. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1
C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1
D. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Bosporus Strait:** Narrowest strait used for international navigation; connects **Black Sea to Sea of Marmara**; splits Istanbul between Europe and Asia. - **Dardanelles Strait:** Connects **Sea of Marmara to Aegean Sea** (and Mediterranean); site of Gallipoli campaign in WWI. - **Strait of Messina:** Connects Tyrrhenian Sea and Ionian Sea; separates **Sicily from the "toe" of Italy**. - **Cook Strait:** Connects Tasman Sea and South Pacific Ocean; separates **North Island from South Island of New Zealand**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Sequence from Black Sea to Mediterranean: **Black Sea -> Bosporus Strait -> Sea of Marmara -> Dardanelles Strait -> Aegean Sea / Mediterranean**!

Question 236

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Parliamentary Sessions & Terms

Consider the following statements regarding the sessions of Parliament: 1. 'Prorogation' terminates a sitting as well as the session of the House, and is done by the President of India. 2. 'Adjournment' terminates a sitting only, and is done by the presiding officer (Speaker / Chairman) of the House. 3. Under Article 100(3), the Quorum to constitute a meeting of either House of Parliament is one-tenth (10%) of the total number of members of the House.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Adjournment:** Suspends work of the sitting for a specified time (hours, days); exercised by Speaker/Chairman. - **Adjournment Sine Die:** Terminating sitting of Parliament without naming a day for reassembly; exercised by Presiding Officer. - **Prorogation:** President issues notification under Article 85(2)(a) ending the entire session (usually done days after adjournment sine die). - **Quorum (Article 100):** Minimum presence required is **$\frac{1}{10} ext{th}$ of total membership** (55 members in Lok Sabha, 25 members in Rajya Sabha). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Prorogation does NOT cause pending bills to lapse! A bill lapses ONLY upon the **Dissolution** of the Lok Sabha under specific conditions governed by Article 107.

Question 237

Subject: General Science (Physics & Environment) | **Topic:** Greenhouse Gases and Global Warming Potentials

Arrange the following greenhouse gases in descending order of their Global Warming Potential (GWP over 100-year horizon, from highest GWP to lowest): 1. Sulphur Hexafluoride (SF_6) 2. Nitrous Oxide (N_2O) 3. Methane (CH_4) 4. Carbon Dioxide (CO_2)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4
B. 1 — 3 — 2 — 4
C. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
D. 4 — 3 — 2 — 1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Global Warming Potential (GWP) measures how much heat a greenhouse gas traps in the atmosphere relative to CO_2 (which has a baseline GWP = 1): 1. **Sulphur Hexafluoride (SF_6):** Highest GWP known; $ ext{GWP} □pprox 23,500$ (used as an electrical insulator in circuit breakers). 2. **Nitrous Oxide (N_2O):** $ ext{GWP} □pprox 273$ to 298 times higher than CO_2. 3. **Methane (CH_4):** $ ext{GWP} □pprox 28$ to 32 times higher than CO_2 over 100 years. 4. **Carbon Dioxide (CO_2):** Baseline reference ($ ext{GWP} = 1$). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Even though SF_6 has the HIGHEST GWP, CO_2 is responsible for the largest share of human-induced global warming because its emission VOLUME is millions of times greater!

Question 238

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Urbanization Demographics in UP (Census 2011)

Consider the following statements regarding urbanization in Uttar Pradesh: 1. In Census 2011, the urban population of Uttar Pradesh was 22.28%, while the rural population was 77.72%. 2. Ghaziabad is the most urbanized district of Uttar Pradesh by percentage of urban population (~67.55%). 3. Shravasti district has the lowest percentage of urban population in Uttar Pradesh (~3.46%).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Urban vs Rural Proportion:** Total UP population = 19.98 crore; Urban = **4.45 crore (22.28%)**; Rural = **15.53 crore (77.72%)**. - **Top 3 Urbanized Districts by %:** 1. **Ghaziabad (67.55%)** 2. Lucknow (66.21%) 3. Kanpur Nagar (65.83%) - **Bottom 3 Urbanized Districts by %:** 1. **Shravasti (3.46%)** 2. Kushi Nagar (4.72%) 3. Maharajganj (5.02%) - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In terms of absolute numbers of urban population, Maharashtra ranks 1st in India, and Uttar Pradesh ranks **2nd in India**!

Question 239

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Ramsar Wetland Superlatives of India

Match List-I (Ramsar Wetland Site) with List-II (State & Superlative) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Site) A. Vembanad-Kol Wetland
B. Renuka Lake
C. Sundarban Wetland
D. Keoladeo National Park

List-II (State & Superlative) 1. Himachal Pradesh; Smallest Ramsar site in India (0.2 sq km)
2. Kerala; Longest lake in India (spans over 96 km)
3. Rajasthan; First Ramsar site of India (1981, with Chilika)
4. West Bengal; Largest Ramsar site in India by surface area (4,230 sq km)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Vembanad-Kol (Kerala):** Longest lake in India; Nehru Trophy Boat Race (*Vallam Kali*) held at Punnamada Lake. - **Renuka Lake (Sirmaur, HP):** Smallest designated wetland in India (~20 hectares / 0.2 sq km); freshwater lake with sacred natural history. - **Sundarban Wetland (WB):** Largest Ramsar site in India (~4,230 sq km); mangrove delta formed by Ganga-Brahmaputra-Meghna. - **Keoladeo Ghana (Bharatpur, Rajasthan):** Declared India's first Ramsar site along with Chilika Lake in October 1981; renowned bird paradise for wintering Siberian cranes. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Tamil Nadu has the **HIGHEST number of Ramsar sites** in India (16 sites), followed by Uttar Pradesh (10 sites)!

Question 240

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** NITI Aayog SDG India Index

Consider the following statements regarding the SDG India Index (4th Edition, 2023–24) released by NITI Aayog: 1. Uttarakhand and Kerala emerged as the joint top-performing States with an overall composite score of 79. 2. Bihar recorded the lowest score among all states. 3. The index tracks progress across all 16 sustainable development goals using targeted socio-economic indicators.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - Released in July 2024 by NITI Aayog; tracks India's performance on Goals 1 to 16 (Goal 17 is qualitative and evaluated at the national level). - **Top States: Uttarakhand and Kerala** tied for the #1 rank with a score of 79, followed by Tamil Nadu (78) and Goa (77). - **Lowest State: Bihar (57)**, preceded by Jharkhand (62) and Nagaland (63). - **Top UT:** Chandigarh (score 77). - Uttar Pradesh moved into the "Front Runner" category (score 67). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** SDG Index Performance bands: Aspirant (0–49), Performer (50–64), Front Runner (65–99), Achiever (100). No state has reached Achiever status yet!

Question 241

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Surat Split (1907) and Lucknow Reunion (1916)

Consider the following statements: 1. The 1907 Surat session of Congress was held on the banks of the Tapi river and presided over by Dr. Rashbehari Ghosh. 2. The split between Moderates and Extremists occurred primarily over the extension of the Swadeshi and Boycott movement beyond Bengal. 3. The reunion of Moderates and Extremists at the 1916 Lucknow session was facilitated largely through the efforts of Annie Besant and Bal Gangadhar Tilak.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **1907 Surat:** Extremists wanted Tilak or Lala Lajpat Rai as president, and insisted on reaffirming the 1906 Calcutta resolutions (Swadeshi, Boycott, Swaraj, National Education). Moderates appointed Rashbehari Ghosh; meeting ended in hurling of shoes and police intervention. - **Ideological Rift:** Extremists insisted boycott must cover all British institutions across India; Moderates wanted boycott limited to foreign cloth and within Bengal. - **1916 Lucknow Reunion:** After Gokhale and Pherozeshah Mehta died in 1915, **Annie Besant and Tilak** brokered the readmission of Extremists into the Congress fold at Lucknow (presided by A.C. Mazumdar). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Do not confuse Dr. Rashbehari Ghosh (Moderate Congress president at Surat 1907 and Madras 1908) with Rash Behari Bose (Revolutionary who threw bomb at Lord Hardinge in 1912 and organized INA in Japan)!

Question 242

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Ashokan Inscriptions and Pillars in Uttar Pradesh

Match List-I (Ashokan Edict / Pillar Site in UP) with List-II (District / Present Location) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Site in UP) A. Ahraura Minor Rock Edict
B. Topra Ashokan Pillar
C. Meerut Ashokan Pillar
D. Kaushambi Pillar (Allahabad-Kosam)

List-II (Location / Shifted To) 1. Originally in Haryana/UP border; shifted to Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi, by Firoz Shah Tughlaq
2. Mirzapur district of Uttar Pradesh
3. Shifted to Delhi Ridge near Bara Hindu Rao Hospital by Firoz Shah Tughlaq
4. Shifted to Allahabad Fort by Mughal Emperor Akbar (contains Harishena's Prayag Prashasti)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Ahraura:** Located in **Mirzapur** district (UP); Minor Rock Edict discovered in 1961 containing vital dates of Buddha's parinirvana. - **Topra Pillar:** Originally located in Topra Kalan (Yamunanagar, Haryana near Saharanpur border); transported on massive 42-wheel cart on Yamuna boats and installed at Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi, by **Firoz Shah Tughlaq**. Contains all 7 Pillar Edicts. - **Meerut Pillar:** Transferred from **Meerut** to Delhi Ridge by Firoz Shah Tughlaq. - **Allahabad-Kosam Pillar:** Originally stood at **Kaushambi**; shifted to Allahabad Fort under **Akbar**; contains Ashoka's Schism Edict and Queen's Edict (Karuvaki), Samudragupta's Prayag Prashasti, and Jahangir's Persian inscriptions. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Shams-i-Siraj Afif's *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi* gives a dramatic eyewitness description of how Firoz Shah Tughlaq transported the Topra and Meerut pillars to Delhi!

Question 243

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Major Coalfields of India

Match List-I (Coalfield) with List-II (State / River Valley Basin) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Coalfield) A. Jharia
B. Raniganj
C. Singrauli
D. Korba

List-II (Location / Basin) 1. Damodar Valley, West Bengal; India's oldest coalfield (mining started 1774)
2. Damodar Valley, Dhanbad (Jharkhand); premier prime coking coal repository
3. Hasdeo River Basin, Chhattisgarh
4. Son River Valley, Madhya Pradesh & Sonbhadra (Uttar Pradesh)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Jharia (Jharkhand):** India's richest source of high-grade metallurgical coking coal; famous for deep subterranean coal fires. - **Raniganj (WB):** Oldest coalmine in India (commercial mining began in 1774 by Sumner and Heatly). - **Singrauli:** Spans Singrauli (MP) and Sonbhadra (UP); has the thickest coal seam in India (Jhingurdah seam ~132 m thick); feeds major thermal power plants. - **Korba (Chhattisgarh):** Hasdeo-Arand coal basin feeding NTPC Korba plant. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Over 98% of India's coal reserves belong to the **Gondwana rock formations** (Permian period ~250 million years old, Damodar, Mahanadi, Son, Godavari valleys). Tertiary coal occurs in Assam, Meghalaya, and J&K!

Question 244

Subject: General Science (Chemistry) | **Topic:** Food Chemistry (Artificial Sweeteners & Preservatives)

Match List-I (Chemical Additive) with List-II (Description / Application) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Additive) A. Aspartame
B. Saccharin
C. Sucralose
D. Sodium Benzoate

List-II (Description / Application) 1. Oldest non-nutritive artificial sweetener (550 times sweeter than cane sugar); excreted unchanged
2. Unstable at cooking temperatures; limited to cold foods and soft drinks
3. Trichloro derivative of sucrose; stable at baking/cooking temperatures
4. Widely used chemical food preservative (C_6H_5COONa); prevents microbial growth in fruit juices

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Aspartame:** Methyl ester of phenylalanine/aspartic acid dipeptide; ~100 times sweeter than sucrose; decomposes at cooking temperatures, hence used strictly in cold soft drinks. - **Saccharin (o-sulfobenzimide):** Discovered in 1879; ~550 times sweeter than sugar; zero calories; harmlessly excreted in urine. - **Sucralose:** Trichlorosucrose; ~600 times sweeter than sugar; appearance and taste like sugar; high thermal stability (used in cooking). - **Sodium Benzoate:** Most common food preservative in tomato ketchups, squashes, and jams (metabolized into hippuric acid). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Alitame is an artificial sweetener that is 2,000 times sweeter than cane sugar! Aspartame cannot be consumed by patients suffering from Phenylketonuria (PKU).

Question 245

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Major Multipurpose Dams on the Betwa River

Which of the following dams in Uttar Pradesh is/are built across the **Betwa River**? 1. Matatila Dam 2. Rajghat Dam 3. Parichha Dam

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three dams are constructed on the **Betwa River**: - **Matatila Dam:** Built in 1958 in **Lalitpur** district of UP; joint project of UP and MP; reservoir known as Laxmibai Sagar. - **Rajghat Dam:** Inter-state multipurpose project between UP and MP on Betwa river in **Lalitpur** district; power and irrigation project. - **Parichha Dam:** Built on Betwa river near **Jhansi**; water is utilized for Parichha Thermal Power Station. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Rihand Dam (Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar) is on **Rihand River** (Sonbhadra); Sukma-Dukma Dam is also on the **Betwa River** in Jhansi!

Question 246

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Project Elephant and Elephant Reserves in UP

Consider the following statements regarding Asian Elephant conservation in India: 1. 'Project Elephant' was launched by the Government of India in February 1992 as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme. 2. The Asian Elephant (*Elephas maximus*) is declared the 'National Heritage Animal' of India. 3. The Terai Elephant Reserve (TER) notified in Uttar Pradesh spans over the Dudhwa Tiger Reserve and Pilibhit Tiger Reserve.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Project Elephant:** Launched in **February 1992** to protect elephant corridors, prevent human-elephant conflict, and ensure welfare of captive elephants. - **National Heritage Animal:** Asian Elephant declared National Heritage Animal of India in **2010** based on Elephant Task Force ("Gajah" report headed by Mahesh Rangarajan). - **Terai Elephant Reserve (TER):** Approved in October 2022 as India's 33rd Elephant Reserve (and 2nd in UP, after Shivalik Elephant Reserve). Spans ~3,049 sq km across **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve and Pilibhit Tiger Reserve** in Lakhimpur Kheri and Pilibhit districts. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** State with maximum wild elephants in India is **Karnataka**, followed by Assam and Kerala!

Question 247

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Currency Convertibility (Current vs Capital Account)

Consider the following statements regarding the convertibility of the Indian Rupee: 1. The Indian Rupee was made fully convertible on the Current Account in August 1994, accepting obligations under Article VIII of the IMF. 2. India currently maintains full (100%) Capital Account convertibility. 3. The S.S. Tarapore Committees (1997 and 2006) laid down preconditions for moving towards Full Capital Account Convertibility.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 3 only
B. 1 and 2 only
C. 2 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1 and 3 are correct: In 1994, following the Liberalized Exchange Rate Management System (LERMS), India achieved **full Current Account Convertibility** (citizens/firms can freely convert currency for trade in goods/services and remittances). The RBI appointed the **Tarapore Committee on Capital Account Convertibility** (1997 & 2006), which recommended prerequisites: gross fiscal deficit below 3.5%, inflation 3–5%, and non-performing assets (NPAs) below 5%. - Statement 2 is incorrect: India has **PARTIAL (not full) Capital Account Convertibility**. While foreign investors and corporations enjoy broad freedom under automatic FDI/FPI routes, domestic residents face statutory ceilings (e.g., Liberalised Remittance Scheme - LRS cap of \$250,000 per financial year). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Remember: India has FULL Current Account Convertibility, but only PARTIAL Capital Account Convertibility!

Question 248

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Global Peace Index 2024

Consider the following statements regarding the Global Peace Index (GPI) 2024: 1. It is published annually by the Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP) based in Sydney, Australia. 2. Iceland has remained the most peaceful country in the world every year since 2008. 3. Yemen was ranked as the least peaceful country in the world in the 2024 index.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **18th Edition of GPI (2024):** Released by IEP Sydney; ranks 163 independent states and territories across 23 indicators grouped into 3 domains: Societal Safety & Security, Ongoing Domestic & International Conflict, and Militarization. - **Top Rank: Iceland** has held the #1 spot continuously since the index began in 2008, followed by Ireland, Austria, and New Zealand. - **Least Peaceful: Yemen** ranked 163rd (last), falling below Sudan, South Sudan, Afghanistan, and Ukraine. - **India:** Ranked **116th** out of 163 nations. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Published by **Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)**, NOT the United Nations or Amnesty International!

Question 249

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Mughal Provincial Administrative Hierarchy

Arrange the administrative divisions of the Mughal Empire in descending territorial hierarchy (from largest to smallest unit): 1. Sarkar (District) 2. Subah (Province) 3. Gram / Mauza (Village) 4. Pargana (Sub-district / Tehsil)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 4 — 3
B. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3
C. 2 — 4 — 1 — 3
D. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Akbar standardized the imperial provincial administration into a 4-tier hierarchy: 1. **Subah (Province):** Headed by *Subedar / Sipahsalar* (executive/military) and *Diwan* (provincial finance/revenue, independent of Subedar). 2. **Sarkar (District):** Headed by *Faujdar* (executive/law and order) and *Amalguzar* (chief revenue collector). 3. **Pargana (Sub-district):** Headed by *Shiqdar* (executive) and *Amil* (revenue collector) and *Qanungo* (revenue records). 4. **Gram / Mauza (Village):** Lowest unit; headed by *Muqaddam / Patel* (village headman) and *Patwari* (village accountant). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Akbar created **12 Subahs** in 1580; added 3 more in the Deccan (Berar, Khandesh, Ahmadnagar) totaling 15. Under Jahangir there were 17, under Shah Jahan 22, and under **Aurangzeb there were 21 Subahs** (maximum number)!

Question 250

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Major World Plateaus & Geographic Features

Match List-I (Plateau of the World) with List-II (Country / Region & Superlative) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Plateau) A. Tibetan Plateau
B. Anatolian Plateau
C. Colorado Plateau
D. Kimberley Plateau

List-II (Location & Feature) 1. Turkey; intermontane plateau between Pontic and Taurus mountains
2. Northwestern Australia; rugged sandstone plateau rich in diamond reserves
3. Highest and largest plateau on Earth ("Roof of the World", average elevation 4,500 m)
4. Southwestern USA; dissected by Colorado river forming the Grand Canyon

Options: A. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2
B. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2
C. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2
D. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Tibetan Plateau:** Intermontane plateau bounded by the Himalayas to the south and Kunlun Mountains to the north; covers ~2.5 million sq km ("Third Pole of the Earth"). - **Anatolian Plateau:** Heart of Asian Turkey; classic intermontane plateau between the Pontic Mountains (north) and Taurus Mountains (south). - **Colorado Plateau:** Famous for horizontal rock strata deeply incised by the Colorado River into the mile-deep **Grand Canyon**. - **Kimberley Plateau:** Located in northern Western Australia; famous for the Argyle diamond pipe. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Pamir Knot is also termed the "Roof of the World", where the Hindu Kush, Tian Shan, Karakoram, and Kunlun ranges converge!

Question 251

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** High-Yield Constitutional Amendments

Match List-I (Constitutional Amendment Act) with List-II (Core Reform) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Amendment) A. 61st Amendment Act, 1988
B. 69th Amendment Act, 1991
C. 52nd Amendment Act, 1985
D. 92nd Amendment Act, 2003

List-II (Core Reform) 1. Disqualification on ground of defection; added Tenth Schedule
2. Lowered voting age from 21 years to 18 years for Lok Sabha and Assemblies
3. Added four languages (Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, and Santhali) to Eighth Schedule
4. Accorded special status to Union Territory of Delhi as 'National Capital Territory of Delhi' (Article 239AA)

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **61st CAA 1988 (effective March 1989):** Amended Article 326 to reduce the minimum voting age from **21 to 18 years** under Rajiv Gandhi. - **69th CAA 1991:** Created NCT of Delhi; established a 70-member Legislative Assembly and 7-member Council of Ministers (Article 239AA). - **52nd CAA 1985:** Anti-Defection Law; inserted Tenth Schedule. - **92nd CAA 2003:** Added **Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali** (BDMS) to the 8th Schedule, expanding the tally of constitutional languages to 22. - **आयोग का**

Trap / Ratta Point: Mnemonic for 8th Schedule amendment languages: - 21st CAA (1967): Sindhi (1) - 71st CAA (1992): Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali (**KMN**) (3) - 92nd CAA (2003): Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali (**BDMS**) (4)!

Question 252

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Classification of Infectious Pathogens

Match List-I (Pathogenic Agent) with List-II (Structural Feature / Example Disease) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Agent) A. Prions
B. Viroids
C. Retroviruses
D. Bacteriophages

List-II (Feature / Disease) 1. Infectious agent consisting ONLY of short, naked single-stranded RNA without protein coat; causes Potato Spindle Tuber disease
2. Abnormally folded infectious proteins lacking any nucleic acid; causes Mad Cow Disease (BSE) and Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease
3. Viruses that possess RNA genome and use Reverse Transcriptase to form DNA (e.g. HIV)
4. Specialized viruses that specifically infect and destroy bacteria

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Prions (Stanley Prusiner, Nobel Prize 1997):** Infectious protein particles with NO genetic material (no DNA/RNA); induce normal proteins to misfold into beta-pleated sheets; cause Bovine Spongiform Encephalopathy (Mad Cow) and Kuru. - **Viroids (T.O. Diener, 1971):** Smaller than viruses; consist solely of low molecular weight, free circular RNA with NO protein capsid. - **Retroviruses:** Contain single-stranded RNA; possess the enzyme *Reverse Transcriptase* that synthesizes DNA from RNA template (e.g., Human Immunodeficiency Virus - HIV). - **Bacteriophages:** Double-stranded DNA viruses with icosahedral head and tail that infect bacteria; abundant in holy Ganges water (responsible for its self-cleansing antibacterial properties). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Prions have PROTEIN only (NO nucleic acid); Viroids have RNA only (NO protein)!

Question 253

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Rainfall & Climatic Extremes in UP

Consider the following statements regarding the climate and rainfall of Uttar Pradesh: 1. Uttar Pradesh experiences a predominantly Subtropical Monsoon climate. 2. Gorakhpur district receives the highest average annual rainfall in the state (approx. 184 cm). 3. Mathura district receives the lowest average annual rainfall in the state (approx. 54 cm).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Climate:** Humid subtropical with dry winters (*Cwg* in Koppen classification); three seasons: Summer (March–June), Rainy (June–September), Winter (October–February). - **Rainfall Distribution:** Monsoon winds (Bay of Bengal branch / *Purvaiya*) enter through the east; rainfall decreases steadily from East to West and from North (Terai) to South (Bundelkhand). - **Highest Rainfall: Gorakhpur (~184.7 cm)** in eastern Terai. - **Lowest Rainfall: Mathura (~54.4 cm)** in western semi-arid border with Rajasthan. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Highest rainfall = **Gorakhpur**; Lowest rainfall = **Mathura**! Rainfall decreases from East to West and from North to South in UP.

Question 254

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Ecological Succession

Consider the following statements regarding ecological succession: 1. Primary succession occurs on newly exposed surfaces where no soil or organic matter previously existed, such as cooled lava flows or bare rocks. 2. Secondary succession begins in areas where a

natural community has been destroyed or disrupted, but the soil and organic substratum remain intact. 3. Lichens typically act as the 'pioneer species' in xerarch primary succession on bare rock.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Primary Succession:** Very slow process taking thousands of years; occurs on barren rock, sand dunes, newly submerged lands. - **Secondary Succession:** Much faster because soil, seeds, and rootstocks already exist (e.g., abandoned farmland, burnt forest). - **Pioneer Species in Xerarch Succession:** Crustose and foliose **Lichens** secrete organic acids to corrode rock minerals, creating a thin layer of soil that allows mosses, herbs, shrubs, and finally trees (*Climax Forest*) to establish. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The entire sequence of communities that successively change in a given area is called a **Sere**; individual transitional communities are called **Seral Stages**!

Question 255

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Deficit Indicators and Zero Primary Deficit

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): When the Primary Deficit of the Government of India is zero, the Fiscal Deficit becomes exactly equal to the interest payments on past debt.
Reason (R): Primary Deficit is defined as Fiscal Deficit minus interest payments made on accumulated borrowings.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - By definition: $$ ext{Primary Deficit} = ext{Fiscal Deficit} - ext{Interest Payments}$$ - If $ ext{Primary Deficit} = 0$: $$0 = ext{Fiscal Deficit} - ext{Interest Payments} \implies ext{Fiscal Deficit} = ext{Interest Payments}$$ - This indicates that the current year's fiscal operations are in balance, and the entire government borrowing is merely servicing the interest liability of historical loans! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Zero Primary Deficit does NOT mean zero fiscal deficit! It simply means new borrowings are equal to interest payments.

Question 256

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Trade Union Movements & AITUC (1920)

Consider the following statements regarding the All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC): 1. It was founded in Bombay on October 31, 1920. 2. Lala Lajpat Rai was elected as the first President of AITUC, and Dewan Chaman Lall was its first General Secretary. 3. N.M. Joshi was the primary organizer behind the establishment of AITUC.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Formation:** Founded in Bombay on October 31, 1920, spurred by the formation of the International Labour Organization (ILO) in 1919. - **Leadership: Lala Lajpat Rai** presided over the inaugural session (criticized capitalism and imperial exploitation). **Dewan Chaman Lall** was General Secretary. - **Key Architect: Narayan Malhar (N.M.) Joshi** was the chief organizer (he also founded the Social Service League in 1911). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In 1929, at the Nagpur session presided by **Jawaharlal Nehru**, the AITUC split into AITUC and Indian Trades Union Federation (led by N.M. Joshi)!

Question 257

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences 2024

The Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel 2024 was awarded to Daron Acemoglu, Simon Johnson, and James A. Robinson for what primary contribution?

Options: A. For studies of how institutions are formed and affect prosperity
B. For experimental approaches to alleviating global poverty
C. For improvements to auction theory and inventions of new auction formats
D. For empirical research on bank runs and financial crises

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The 2024 Economics Nobel was awarded to **Daron Acemoglu (MIT), Simon Johnson (MIT), and James A. Robinson (University of Chicago)** (co-authors of the landmark book *Why Nations Fail*). - Awarded "for studies of how institutions are formed and affect prosperity": - Demonstrated that societies with poor rule of law and **"extractive institutions"** exploit populations and fail to generate sustained growth. - Societies that developed **"inclusive institutions"** guaranteeing property rights, democracy, and equality of opportunity achieved lasting prosperity. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Claudia Goldin won the Economics Nobel in 2023 for her work on women's labor market outcomes!

Question 258

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Sangam Eco-Zones (Thinai System)

Match List-I (Sangam Thinai / Eco-Zone) with List-II (Landscape & Occupation) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Thinai) A. Kurinji
B. Mullai
C. Marudham
D. Neydal

List-II (Landscape & Activity) 1. Pastoral / Grassland; cattle rearing and dairy farming
2. Hilly / Mountainous terrain; hunting and gathering of honey/roots
3. Coastal / Littoral tracts; fishing and salt-making
4. Fertile agricultural plains; wet-paddy cultivation

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The Sangam *Tolkappiyam* divides Tamilakam into 5 physiographic landscapes (*Ainthinai*): - **Kurinji (Hilly):** Presided by god Murugan (Seyon); hunting and honey gathering. - **Mullai (Pastoral/Forest):** Presided by god Mayon (Vishnu); cattle rearing and shifting cultivation. - **Marudham (Agricultural):** Presided by god Vendan (Indra); settled rice farming. - **Neydal (Coastal):** Presided by god Varunan; fishing and salt manufacturing. - **Palai (Arid/Desert):** Presided by goddess Korravai; highway robbery and plunder. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Kurinji = Hills; Mullai = Pastoral; Marudham = Plains; Neydal = Coast; Palai = Desert.

Question 259

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Major Lakes of Peninsular India

Match List-I (Peninsular Lake) with List-II (State & Geographical Characteristic) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Lake) A. Kolleru Lake
B. Pulicat Lake
C. Lonar Lake
D. Sasthamkotta Lake

List-II (State & Characteristic) 1. Andhra Pradesh & Tamil Nadu border; second largest brackish water lagoon in India; separated by Sriharikota barrier island
2. Andhra Pradesh; freshwater lake situated between the deltas of Godavari and Krishna rivers
3. Kerala (Kollam); largest freshwater lake in Kerala ("Queen of Lakes")
4. Maharashtra (Buldhana); hyper-saline soda lake formed by hypervelocity meteorite impact

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Kolleru Lake (AP):** Natural freshwater lake between Godavari and Krishna deltas; Ramsar site; home to migratory birds (Pelican sanctuary). - **Pulicat Lake:** Second largest lagoon in India (after Chilika); separated from Bay of Bengal by the barrier island of **Sriharikota** (Satish Dhawan Space Centre). - **Lonar Lake (Buldhana, Maharashtra):** Unique meteorite impact crater lake in basaltic rock; declared Ramsar site in 2020. - **Sasthamkotta Lake (Kerala):** Largest freshwater lake in Kerala; water contains *Cavaborus* larva which cleans water by consuming bacteria. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Kolleru is FRESHWATER, while Pulicat is BRACKISH water! Both are located in Andhra Pradesh.

Question 260

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Election Commission of India (Article 324 & 2023 Law)

Consider the following statements regarding the Election Commission of India (ECI): 1. Under Article 324, the superintendence, direction, and control of the preparation of electoral rolls and conduct of elections to Parliament, State Legislatures, and the offices of President and Vice-President are vested in the ECI. 2. The Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 provides for a 3-member Selection Committee comprising the Prime Minister, a Union Cabinet Minister, and the Leader of Opposition / largest opposition party in Lok Sabha. 3. The Election Commission conducts elections to Panchayats and Municipalities in the States.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1 and 2 are correct: ECI conducts elections to Parliament, State Assemblies/Councils, President, and Vice-President. Under the 2023 enactment, the selection committee consists of: Prime Minister (Chairperson), Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the PM (replacing the Chief Justice of India who was included under the earlier SC judgment in *Anoop Baranwal*). - Statement 3 is incorrect: Elections to local bodies (Panchayats and Municipalities) are conducted NOT by the ECI, but by the **State Election Commission (SEC)** established under Articles 243K and 243ZA! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Common confusion: ECI has NO jurisdiction over Panchayat or Municipal elections! Those are conducted strictly by State Election Commissions.

Question 261

Subject: General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Nuclear Physics & Radioactive Emissions

Match List-I (Radioactive Emission) with List-II (Physical Nature & Properties) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Emission) A. Alpha ($□lpha$) Particles
B. Beta ($□eta^-$) Particles
C. Gamma (γ) Rays
D. Half-Life ($T_{1/2}$)

List-II (Nature & Property) 1. High-energy electromagnetic radiation; highest penetration power; zero charge and zero mass
2. Doubly charged Helium nuclei ($^4_2He^{2+}$); highest ionizing power; stopped by a single sheet of paper
3. Time required for half of the radioactive nuclei in a sample to undergo decay ($T_{1/2} = ↑rac{0.693}{\lambda}$)
4. High-speed electrons (e^-); moderate ionizing and penetration power; stopped by thin aluminium sheet

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **$□lpha$-particles:** Identical to Helium nuclei (^4_2He); charge $+2e$, mass $4 ext{ amu}$; **Highest ionizing power**, lowest penetration. - **$□eta$-particles:** High-velocity electrons (*${-1}^0e$); charge $-e$, negligible mass;*

intermediate penetration. - ***γ-rays:*** *Electromagnetic photons of extremely short wavelength; uncharged;* ***Highest penetration power*** *(requires thick lead/concrete shields).* - ***Half-Life ($T_{1/2}$):*** *Characteristic constant for every radioactive isotope ($T{1/2} = ↟rac{\ln 2}{\lambda} □pprox ↟rac{0.693}{\lambda}$); independent of temperature, pressure, or physical state.* - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Penetration power order: **$\gamma > □eta > □lpha$**! Ionizing power order is the exact reverse: **$□lpha > □eta > \gamma$**!

Question 262

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Eminent Historical Figures Born in UP

Match List-I (Historical Personality) with List-II (Birthplace in Uttar Pradesh) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Personality) A. Amir Khusrau (*Tuti-e-Hind*)
B. Ziauddin Barani
C. Birbal (Mahesh Das)
D. Mirza Ghalib

List-II (Birthplace in UP) 1. Baran (modern Bulandshahr)
2. Patiyali (Kasganj district)
3. Agra (Akbarabad)
4. Kalpi (Jalaun district)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Amir Khusrau (1253–1325 CE):** Born at **Patiyali** (formerly Etah, now in **Kasganj** district); called *Tuti-e-Hind* (Parrot of India); invented Qawwali, Khayal, Sitar, and Tabla; disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya; served in courts of 7 Sultans (from Balban to Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq). - **Ziauddin Barani:** Born at **Baran (Bulandshahr)** in 1285 CE; authored *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi*. - **Birbal (Mahesh Das):** Born at **Kalpi (Jalaun district)** in 1528 CE; chief advisor and Navratna of Akbar. - **Mirza Asadullah Baig Khan (Ghalib):** Born in **Agra** in 1797; greatest classical Urdu and Persian ghazal poet. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Tulsidas was born at **Rajapur (Chitrakoot)** / Soron (Kasganj); Surdas was born at **Runkata (Agra)**; Kabir was born in **Varanasi**!

Question 263

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Protected Area Categories under Wildlife Protection Act

Consider the following statements regarding Protected Areas in India: 1. In a National Park, no human activities (including livestock grazing, timber harvesting, or private land ownership) are permitted. 2. In a Wildlife Sanctuary, certain limited human activities and traditional rights (like regulated cattle grazing and collection of minor forest produce) may be permitted by the Chief Wildlife Warden. 3. A National Park can be declared by an executive notification of the State Government, but its boundaries can be altered ONLY upon the recommendation of the National Board for Wildlife (NBWL).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **National Parks (Section 35 of WPA 1972):** Enjoy the highest degree of protection; boundaries are fixed by legislation; complete ban on grazing, cultivation, and private rights. - **Wildlife Sanctuaries (Section 18/26A):** Species-oriented; regulated biotic interference and grazing may be permitted if not prejudicial to wildlife. - **Boundary Alteration:** Under the Supreme Court directives and Section 35(5) of WPA, no alteration of the boundaries of a National Park or Sanctuary can be made without the prior recommendation of the **National Board for Wildlife (chaired by the Prime Minister)**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** A Sanctuary can be upgraded into a National Park, but a National Park CANNOT be downgraded into a Sanctuary!

Question 264

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Classical Cannons of Taxation

Adam Smith in his monumental work *The Wealth of Nations* (1776) laid down four fundamental 'Canons of Taxation'. Which of the following is NOT one of Adam Smith's four original canons?

Options: A. Canon of Equality / Ability
B. Canon of Certainty
C. Canon of Convenience
D. Canon of Elasticity

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Adam Smith enunciated **Four Classical Canons of Taxation**: 1. **Canon of Equality / Ability:** Tax should be levied according to the taxpayer's ability to pay (progressive taxation). 2. **Canon of Certainty:** Time of payment, manner of payment, and exact amount to be paid must be clear and plain to the contributor. 3. **Canon of Convenience:** Every tax ought to be levied at the time or in the manner in which it is most convenient for the contributor to pay (e.g. TDS at time of salary credit). 4. **Canon of Economy:** The cost of collecting the tax should be as small as possible relative to the revenue yield. - The Canon of Elasticity and Canon of Productivity were introduced later by modern economists like C.F. Bastable! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The four original canons are strictly: **Equality, Certainty, Convenience, and Economy**!

Question 265

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** 70th National Film Awards (2024)

At the 70th National Film Awards announced in 2024, the Best Actress award was shared jointly by:

Options: A. Nithya Menen and Manasi Parekh
B. Alia Bhatt and Kriti Sanon
C. Kangana Ranaut and Vidya Balan
D. Parvathy Thiruvothu and Sai Pallavi

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - At the 70th National Film Awards (for films certified in 2022): - **Best Actress:** Awarded jointly to: 1. **Nithya Menen** for her performance in the Tamil film *Thiruchitrambalam*. 2. **Manasi Parekh** for her performance in the Gujarati film *Kutch Express*. - **Best Actor:** Rishab Shetty for *Kantara* (Kannada). - **Best Director:** Sooraj R. Barjatya for *Uunchai*. - **Best Feature Film:** *Aattam* (Malayalam, directed by Anand Ekarshi). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In the 69th National Film Awards, Best Actress was shared by Alia Bhatt (*Gangubai Kathiawadi*) and Kriti Sanon (*Mimi*); in the 70th it was Nithya Menen and Manasi Parekh!

Question 266

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Vijayanagara Nayankara & Ayagar Systems

Consider the following statements regarding the administration of the Vijayanagara Empire: 1. Under the 'Nayankara System', the king granted military chiefs called *Nayakas* territorial tracts called *Amaram* in exchange for maintaining a fixed contingent of troops and paying annual tribute. 2. The 'Ayagar System' was an organization of village administration where a body of twelve functionaries (*Ayagars*) managed village affairs on a hereditary basis. 3. The Vijayanagara gold coin was known as 'Varaha' (or Pagoda).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Nayankara System:** Distinctive feudal-military institution; *Amaranayakas* held land grants (*Amaram*) and remitted fixed revenue to the treasury while keeping standing military contingents ready for royal call. - **Ayagar System:** Every village was an autonomous administrative unit served by **12 functionaries (Ayagars)**, including the Karnam (accountant), Gauda (headman), Talayari (watchman), potter, blacksmith, etc., who were granted tax-free land (*Manyam*) for their upkeep. - **Currency:** Gold coins were called **Varaha** (weighing ~52 grains, carrying images of Vishnu's boar incarnation, Shiva-Parvati, etc.); European travelers called them *Pagodas*. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Krishnadeva Raya outlined his political philosophy in his Telugu masterpiece **Amuktamalyada**!

Question 267

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** Planetary Winds of the Southern Hemisphere

The maritime westerly winds that blow with furious strength between 40° S and 60° S latitudes in the Southern Hemisphere are popularly termed: 1. "Roaring Forties" between 40° S and 50° S 2. "Furious Fifties" at 50° S 3. "Shrieking (Screaming) Sixties" at 60° S

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three descriptions are correct: - In the Southern Hemisphere, the vast uninterrupted expanse of open oceans provides almost zero frictional resistance from landmasses. - Consequently, the **Westerlies** blow with ferocious, persistent velocity throughout the year: - **Roaring Forties:** 40° to 50° South latitude. - **Furious Fifties:** 50° South latitude. - **Shrieking / Screaming Sixties:** 60° South latitude. - Sailors historically utilized these winds on the "Clipper route" sailing from Europe to Australia. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** These terms apply ONLY to the **Southern Hemisphere**, where ocean dominates land!

Question 268

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Inter-State Council (Article 263)

Consider the following statements regarding the Inter-State Council: 1. The Inter-State Council is established under Article 263 of the Constitution by the President of India. 2. It was first constituted in 1990 on the recommendations of the Sarkaria Commission on Centre-State Relations. 3. The Prime Minister of India serves as the Chairman of the Inter-State Council.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Constitutional Provision:** Article 263 empowers the President to establish an Inter-State Council if public interest would be served. - **Establishment:** Set up on May 28, 1990, by Presidential order following the landmark recommendations of the **Sarkaria Commission (1988)**. - **Composition:** - **Chairman:** Prime Minister of India. - **Members:** Chief Ministers of all States, CMs of UTs having assemblies, Administrators of UTs without assemblies, and 6 Union Cabinet Ministers nominated by the PM. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Inter-State Council is a CONSTITUTIONAL body (Article 263), whereas the Zonal Councils are STATUTORY bodies established under the States Reorganisation Act, 1956!

Question 269

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Human Excretory System & Nephron Physiology

Consider the following statements regarding the human kidney: 1. The Nephron is the structural and functional microscopic filtration unit of the kidney. 2. Glomerular Ultrafiltration occurs under high hydrostatic pressure across the podocytes of Bowman's capsule. 3. The Loop of Henle is primarily responsible for the concentration of urine via a counter-current multiplier mechanism.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - Each kidney contains ~1 million **Nephrons**. - **Ultrafiltration:** Occurs in the Malpighian body (Glomerulus + Bowman's Capsule); blood is filtered through 3 layers into the capsular space; GFR (Glomerular Filtration Rate) is ~125 mL/min or **180 litres per day**! - **Reabsorption:** Over 99% of the filtrate is reabsorbed along the proximal convoluted tubule (PCT) and Loop of Henle (only ~1.5 litres of concentrated urine is excreted daily). - **Loop of Henle & Vasa Recta:** Counter-current mechanism maintains a hyperosmotic medullary gradient, enabling production of concentrated urine. - **आयोग**

का Trap / Ratta Point: The primary site of complete reabsorption of glucose and amino acids is the **Proximal Convoluted Tubule (PCT)**!

Question 270

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Geographical Indications (GI Tags) of UP

Match List-I (GI Tagged Craft of UP) with List-II (Producing Center) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Craft) A. Nizamabad Black Pottery
B. Kalanamak Rice
C. Shajar Stone Craft
D. Handmade Paper

List-II (District in UP) 1. Banda
2. Azamgarh
3. Kalpi (Jalaun)
4. Siddharthnagar

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-4, B-2, C-1, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Nizamabad Black Pottery:** Traditional lustrous dark pottery decorated with silver zinc-mercury inlay; located in **Azamgarh** district. - **Kalanamak Rice:** Aromatic rice featuring black husk and scented grains ("Buddha's Rice"); native to **Siddharthnagar** and surrounding Terai districts. - **Shajar Stone Craft:** Rare translucent dendrite agate gemstone found in Ken river bed in **Banda** district. - **Handmade Paper:** Century-old craft tradition flourishing in **Kalpi (Jalaun)** district. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Uttar Pradesh holds the **HIGHEST number of GI tagged products** in India (surpassing 69+ GI tags)!

Question 271

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Carbon Sequestration & Types of Carbon

Match List-I (Carbon Classification) with List-II (Ecological Reservoir / Source) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Carbon Type) A. Blue Carbon
B. Green Carbon
C. Black Carbon
D. Brown Carbon

List-II (Reservoir / Source) 1. Carbon sequestered by terrestrial ecosystems, forests, and soils through photosynthesis
2. Carbon stored in coastal and marine ecosystems (mangroves, tidal salt marshes, seagrasses)
3. Light-absorbing organic carbon formed by incomplete combustion of biomass (wood smoke, smoldering fires)
4. Soot particles produced by incomplete combustion of fossil fuels, biofuels, and diesel engines

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Blue Carbon:** Carbon captured by the world's coastal and ocean ecosystems (mangroves, marshes, seagrasses sequester carbon up to 10 times faster per hectare than terrestrial tropical forests). - **Green Carbon:** Carbon incorporated into plant biomass and soils in terrestrial forests and agricultural ecosystems. - **Black Carbon (Soot):** Pure carbonaceous aerosol produced by combustion of diesel and biomass; strong short-lived climate pollutant that deposits on snow and accelerates glacier melt. - **Brown Carbon:** Light-absorbing brown organic carbon aerosols from wood combustion and wildfires. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Blue Carbon ecosystems sequester carbon permanently in sediments for thousands of years without saturating!

Question 272

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Cabinet Mission Plan (1946)

Consider the following statements regarding the Cabinet Mission Plan (May 1946): 1. It explicitly rejected the demand for a sovereign, independent Pakistan. 2. It proposed a three-tiered administrative structure with an All-India Union controlling Foreign Affairs, Defence, and Communications. 3. It proposed grouping provincial assemblies into three sections: Section A (Hindu-majority provinces), Section B (Muslim-majority northwestern provinces), and Section C (Muslim-majority northeastern provinces).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - Sent in March 1946 (Lord Pethick-Lawrence, Stafford Cripps, A.V. Alexander). - **Rejection of Pakistan:** Concluded a separate sovereign Pakistan would be economically unviable and create enormous minority problems. - **Union Government:** Limited only to Defence, External Affairs, and Communications; residual powers rested with provinces. - **Grouping of Provinces:** - *Section A:* Madras, Bombay, UP, Bihar, Central Provinces, Orissa. - *Section B:* Punjab, NWFP, Sindh. - *Section C:* Bengal and Assam. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Constituent Assembly of India was formed in November 1946 under the scheme formulated by the **Cabinet Mission Plan**!

Question 273

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Industrial Policy Resolution of 1956

The Industrial Policy Resolution (IPR) of 1956, often described as the "Economic Constitution of India", classified Indian industries into how many categories?

Options: A. Two
B. Three
C. Four
D. Five

Answer: B

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - IPR 1956 formed the basis of the Second Five-Year Plan (Mahalanobis model) and divided all industries into **Three distinct Schedules**: 1. **Schedule A (17 industries):** Reserved exclusively for the State (atomic energy, defense equipment, heavy iron & steel, heavy plant machinery, coal, railways, aircraft). 2. **Schedule B (12 industries):** Mixed sector where State would progressively expand, but private enterprise would supplement State efforts (fertilizers, synthetic rubber, chemical pulp, road transport). 3. **Schedule C (Remaining industries):** Left to the private sector, but regulated through industrial licensing (*License Raj*) under the Industries (Development and Regulation) Act, 1951. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** IPR 1956 laid down the foundation of the "Socialistic Pattern of Society" adopted at the 1955 Avadi session of Congress!

Question 274

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** National Events & Infrastructure 2024

Consider the following statements regarding the 78th Independence Day celebrations on August 15, 2024: 1. The official theme of the 78th Independence Day was "Viksit Bharat @ 2047". 2. Prime Minister Narendra Modi delivered his 11th consecutive Independence Day speech from the ramparts of the Red Fort. 3. The 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana' was highlighted, which aims to provide up to 300 units of free electricity every month to one crore households through rooftop solar installations.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **78th Independence Day (15 August 2024):** Theme was "Viksit Bharat @ 2047" (developed nation by centenary of independence). - PM Modi delivered his **11th consecutive address** (surpassing Manmohan Singh's 10 addresses; behind only Jawaharlal Nehru with 17 and Indira Gandhi with 16). - **PM Surya Ghar Yojana:** Launched in February 2024 with an outlay of ₹75,021 crore; provides up to **300 units of free solar power per month** to 1 crore households. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Subsidies under PM Surya Ghar: ₹30,000 for 1 kW systems, ₹60,000 for 2 kW systems, and ₹78,000 for 3 kW or higher systems!

Question 275

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Harappan Trade and Raw Material Sources

Match List-I (Raw Material Imported by Harappans) with List-II (Source Region) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Raw Material) A. Copper
B. Lapis Lazuli
C. Tin
D. Gold

List-II (Source Region) 1. Khetri mines (Rajasthan) and Oman (Magan)
2. Shortughai / Badakhshan (Afghanistan)
3. Afghanistan and Iran
4. Kolar (Karnataka) and Afghanistan

Options: A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
C. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4
D. A-4, B-2, C-3, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Copper:** Sourced locally from **Khetri mines** in Rajasthan; also imported from **Oman (Magan)** in the Arabian peninsula (chemical analysis shows traces of nickel in both Harappan and Omani copper artifacts). - **Lapis Lazuli:** Deep-blue metamorphic gemstone obtained from the Harappan trading colony of **Shortughai** in Badakhshan, northeast Afghanistan. - **Tin:** Scarce in India; imported from **Afghanistan and Iran** to alloy with copper to manufacture bronze. - **Gold:** Sourced from **Kolar** mines in Karnataka and river sands of northern Afghanistan. - **Steatite:** Sourced from Rajasthan and Gujarat. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Mesopotamian cuneiform texts refer to the Harappan region as **Meluhha**, Oman as **Magan**, and Bahrain as **Dilmun**!

Question 276

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** Highest Mountain Peaks of the Himalayas

Match List-I (Himalayan Peak) with List-II (Mountain Range & State / Region) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Peak) A. K2 (Godwin Austen)
B. Kanchenjunga
C. Nanda Devi
D. Namcha Barwa

List-II (Range & Location) 1. Great Himalayas; Sikkim on India-Nepal border (8,586 m)
2. Karakoram Range; Ladakh (POK) (8,611 m)
3. Easternmost anchor of Great Himalayas; Arunachal Pradesh / Tibet border (7,782 m)
4. Garhwal Himalayas; Chamoli district, Uttarakhand (7,817 m)

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
D. A-3, B-1, C-4, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **K2 (Godwin Austen):** Second highest peak on Earth (8,611 m); located in the **Karakoram range** in Gilgit-Baltistan (India claims as highest peak in Indian territory). - **Kanchenjunga:** Third highest peak in the world (8,586 m); **highest peak located within undisputed Indian territory** (Sikkim). - **Nanda Devi:** Highest peak located *entirely within* a single Indian state (7,817 m, Chamoli, Uttarakhand); ringed by a sanctuary wall. - **Namcha Barwa:** Eastern terminus of the Great Himalayas around which the Brahmaputra (Tsangpo) river bends sharply in a hairpin turn (*Syntaxial Bend*). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Kanchenjunga is in the GREAT HIMALAYAS; K2 is in the KARAKORAM RANGE (Trans-Himalayas)!

Question 277

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Sixteenth Finance Commission (16th FC)

Consider the following statements regarding the 16th Finance Commission of India: 1. It was constituted by the President of India on December 31, 2023, under Article 280 of the Constitution. 2. Dr. Arvind Panagariya (former Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog) was appointed

as its Chairman. 3. The recommendations of the 16th Finance Commission will cover a five-year period starting from April 1, 2026.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Constituted:** Under Article 280(1) by the President on 31 December 2023. - **Chairman:** Noted economist **Dr. Arvind Panagariya** (Ritvik Ranjanam Pandey appointed as Secretary). - **Award Period:** The commission is mandated to submit its report by October 31, 2025, covering the 5-year award period from **April 1, 2026 to March 31, 2031**. - Terms of Reference include: division of tax proceeds between Union and States, grants-in-aid under Article 275, augmenting consolidated funds of states for panchayats/municipalities, and disaster management financing. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** 14th FC was chaired by Y.V. Reddy (recommended 42%); 15th FC was chaired by N.K. Singh (recommended 41%); 16th FC is chaired by Arvind Panagariya!

Question 278

Subject: General Science (Chemistry) | **Topic:** Synthetic Polymers and Fibers

Match List-I (Synthetic Fiber / Polymer) with List-II (Chemical Nature & Distinct Use) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Fiber / Polymer) A. Nylon-6,6
B. Rayon
C. Kevlar
D. Dacron (Terylene)

List-II (Nature & Use) 1. Regenerated semi-synthetic cellulose fiber ("Artificial Silk")
2. Fully synthetic polyamide fiber prepared from adipic acid and hexamethylenediamine
3. Aromatic polyamide (aramid); exceptionally high tensile strength; bulletproof jackets
4. Polyester fiber formed from ethylene glycol and terephthalic acid; crease-resistant fabrics

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4
C. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
D. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Nylon-6,6:** First fully synthetic commercial fiber; condensation polymer of hexamethylenediamine and adipic acid; high tensile strength, used in bristles, ropes, parachutes. - **Rayon:** Regenerated cellulose derived from wood pulp chemically treated with carbon disulfide (CS_2); known as **Artificial Silk**. - **Kevlar (poly-para-phenylene terephthalamide):** Heat-resistant aramid fiber 5 times stronger than steel on an equal weight basis; used in bulletproof vests, helmets, and composite armor. - **Dacron / Terylene:** Common polyester prepared by condensation of ethylene glycol and terephthalic acid. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Rayon is a SEMI-SYNTHETIC fiber (because its raw material is natural wood cellulose), whereas Nylon is a FULLY SYNTHETIC fiber!

Question 279

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Renewable Energy & Solar Projects in UP

Consider the following statements regarding renewable energy initiatives in Uttar Pradesh: 1. Uttar Pradesh Solar Energy Policy 2022 aims to achieve 22,000 MW of solar power capacity by 2026–27. 2. A large floating solar power plant has been installed on the reservoir of the Rihand Dam in Sonbhadra district. 3. Ayodhya is being developed as a model "Solar City" of Uttar Pradesh.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **UP Solar Energy Policy 2022:** Targets **22,000 MW** of solar capacity in 5 years (including 14,000 MW utility-scale solar parks, 6,000 MW rooftop solar, and 2,000 MW solar agricultural pumps under PM-KUSUM). - **Floating Solar:** NTPC constructed a floating solar PV project on Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar reservoir at Rihand (Sonbhadra). - **Model Solar City: Ayodhya** has been developed as UP's pioneer Solar City with solar streetlights, solar trees, and a 40 MW solar plant installed by NTPC Green Energy. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UP's solar parks are concentrated heavily in the **Bundelkhand region** (Jalaun, Jhansi, Lalitpur, Banda) due to high solar irradiance!

Question 280

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Rationalized Schedules of Wildlife Protection Act

Match List-I (Schedule under Amended Wildlife Protection Act) with List-II (Protected Category) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Schedule) A. Schedule I
B. Schedule II
C. Schedule III
D. Schedule IV

List-II (Protected Category) 1. Plant species that are prohibited from being picked, uprooted, or acquired
2. Animal species that enjoy the highest level of absolute protection (highest penalties for poaching)
3. Animal species subjected to lesser degree of protection than Schedule I
4. Specimens of flora and fauna listed in the Appendices of CITES

Options: A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Under the Wildlife (Protection) Amendment Act 2022 (effective from April 2023), the schedules were rationalized from 6 to **4**: - **Schedule I:** Highest priority fauna (e.g. Tiger, Lion, Elephant, Snow Leopard, Gangetic Dolphin, Great Indian Bustard). Poaching invites minimum 3 to 7 years imprisonment. - **Schedule II:** Animal species with lesser degree of protection. - **Schedule III:** Protected plant species (e.g. Beddomes' cycad, Blue Vanda, Pitcher plant). - **Schedule IV:** Species scheduled under CITES (Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Vermin schedule (Schedule V) was completely REPEALED in the 2022 amendment!

Question 281

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Revolutionary Movement in Bengal (Chittagong Armoury Raid)

Consider the following statements regarding the Chittagong Armoury Raid (April 1930): 1. It was planned and led by Surya Sen, popularly known among his followers as 'Master Da'. 2. The revolutionaries operated under the banner of the Indian Republican Army (Chittagong Branch). 3. Women revolutionaries Pritilata Waddedar and Kalpana Datta actively participated in the revolutionary actions led by Surya Sen.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Surya Sen (Master Da):** A national school teacher in Chittagong; organized the raid on April 18, 1930, seizing two British armouries and proclaiming a provisional revolutionary government. - **Battle of Jalalabad Hill (22 April 1930):** Revolutionaries fought heroically against British troops. - **Women Martyrs:** - **Pritilata Waddedar:** Led the raid on Pahartali European Club in September 1932; consumed potassium cyanide to avoid arrest (first woman martyr of revolutionary movement). - **Kalpana Datta:** Fought alongside Surya Sen; arrested and sentenced to transportation for life. - Surya Sen was arrested in February 1933 and hanged on January 12, 1934. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Bina Das shot at Bengal Governor Stanley Jackson at Calcutta University convocation in 1932! Santi Ghosh and Suniti Chaudhary shot dead district magistrate Stevens in Comilla in 1931!

Question 282

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Monetary Policy Framework & MPC Composition

Consider the following statements regarding the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of India: 1. The MPC was given statutory backing under Section 45ZB of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. 2. The committee consists of six members: three from the RBI (including the Governor) and three appointed by the Central Government. 3. The Governor of the RBI serves as the ex-officio Chairperson of the MPC and possesses a second or casting vote in case of a tie.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Constituted:** In 2016 based on Urjit Patel Committee recommendations. - **Membership (6 members):** 1. RBI Governor (Chairperson) 2. RBI Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy 3. One officer of the RBI nominated by the Central Board 4–6. Three external experts appointed by the Central Government for a 4-year term (not eligible for reappointment). - **Voting:** Each member has one vote; in the event of an equality of votes, the **Governor has a casting vote**. - **Target:** Maintain Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation at **4% with a tolerance band of +/- 2%** (2% to 6%). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** External members of the MPC hold office for a fixed term of **4 years and are NOT eligible for reappointment**!

Question 283

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** World Happiness Report 2024

Consider the following statements regarding the World Happiness Report 2024 published by the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network: 1. Finland was ranked as the happiest country in the world for the seventh consecutive year. 2. The rankings are based on six key variables: GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity, and corruption perception. 3. India was ranked 126th out of 143 countries surveyed.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - Released annually on March 20 (UN International Day of Happiness) by the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN) using Gallup World Poll data. - **Top Countries: Finland** ranked #1 for 7 years running, followed by Denmark, Iceland, and Sweden. - **Bottom Country:** Afghanistan ranked 143rd (least happy nation). - **India:** Maintained its rank at **126th out of 143 nations**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** For the first time in over a decade, neither the United States (23rd) nor Germany (24th) made the top 20 list!

Question 284

Subject: Medieval Indian History | **Topic:** Dynasties of Delhi Sultanate Chronology

Arrange the five dynasties of the Delhi Sultanate in chronological sequence of their rule: 1. Khalji Dynasty 2. Mamluk (Slave) Dynasty 3. Lodi Dynasty 4. Sayyid Dynasty 5. Tughlaq Dynasty

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 5 — 4 — 3
B. 1 — 2 — 5 — 4 — 3
C. 2 — 5 — 1 — 4 — 3
D. 2 — 1 — 4 — 5 — 3

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The Delhi Sultanate lasted from 1206 to 1526 CE across 5 successive dynasties: 1. **Mamluk / Ilbari / Slave Dynasty (1206–1290 CE):** Founded by Qutbuddin Aibak (84 years). 2. **Khalji Dynasty (1290–1320 CE):** Founded by Jalaluddin Khalji (30 years; shortest ruling dynasty). 3. **Tughlaq Dynasty (1320–1414 CE):** Founded by Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (94 years;

longest ruling dynasty). 4. **Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451 CE):** Founded by Khizr Khan (37 years). 5. **Lodi Dynasty (1451–1526 CE):** Founded by Bahlul Lodi; first Afghan dynasty (75 years); ended with Babur defeating Ibrahim Lodi at 1st Panipat. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Longest ruling dynasty = **Tughlaqs (94 years)**; Shortest ruling dynasty = **Khaljis (30 years)**! Mnemonic: **S-K-T-S-L** (Slave, Khalji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, Lodi).

Question 285

Subject: World Geography | **Topic:** International Date Line (IDL)

Consider the following statements regarding the International Date Line (IDL): 1. The International Date Line roughly corresponds to the 180° meridian of longitude passing through the Pacific Ocean. 2. A traveler crossing the Date Line from West to East GAINS a day (repeats the same calendar date). 3. The International Date Line is not a straight line, but zig-zags to avoid dividing land territories and island groups (such as the Aleutian Islands and Kiribati).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Course:** Passes through the central Pacific Ocean along 180° longitude; established at the 1884 International Meridian Conference. - **Zig-zag Deviations:** Deviates east at the Bering Strait to keep all of Siberia in one date; bends west around the Aleutian Islands to keep them in Alaska's date; bends east around Kiribati (Line Islands). - **Crossing the IDL:** - **West to East (Asia to America):** GAIN a day (e.g., if you cross on Monday, it becomes Sunday on the other side). - **East to West (America to Asia):** LOSE a day (e.g., Sunday becomes Monday). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Crossing West to East = GAIN a day (go back in calendar date); Crossing East to West = LOSE a day (advance by one calendar date)!

Question 286

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Writ Jurisdiction Comparison (Article 32 vs Article 226)

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R):

Assertion (A): The writ jurisdiction of a High Court under Article 226 is wider than that of the Supreme Court under Article 32.
Reason (R): While the Supreme Court can issue writs only for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights, a High Court can issue writs for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights as well as for "any other ordinary legal purpose".

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
B. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)
C. (A) is true, but (R) is false
D. (A) is false, but (R) is true

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Assertion is true: Article 226 provides a broader scope of writ jurisdiction than Article 32. - Reason is true: - **Supreme Court (Article 32):** Can issue writs ONLY for violations of Part III (Fundamental Rights). It CANNOT issue writs for ordinary legal rights. Moreover, Article 32 is itself a Fundamental Right! - **High Court (Article 226):** Can issue writs for Fundamental Rights AND for "any other purpose" (ordinary legal/statutory rights). - However, the Supreme Court's territorial reach covers the entire territory of India, whereas a High Court's jurisdiction is limited to its state (or where the cause of action arises). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The remedy under Article 32 is a GUARANTEED Fundamental Right (SC cannot refuse remedy); whereas remedy under Article 226 is discretionary!

Question 287

Subject: General Science (Physics) | **Topic:** Mechanical Properties of Solids (Elasticity)

Consider the following statements regarding elasticity and Hooke's Law: 1. Hooke's Law states that within the elastic limit, stress is directly proportional to strain ($ ext{Stress} = E imes ext{Strain}$). 2. Young's Modulus of elasticity (Y) applies to tensile/compressive deformation of solids along length. 3. Steel is more elastic than rubber because steel requires a much greater deforming force to produce the same strain.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Hooke's Law:** Formulated by Robert Hooke in 1676; ratio of stress to strain is constant (Modulus of Elasticity). - **Young's Modulus ($Y = rac{F/A}{\Delta L/L}$):** Measures resistance of a material to longitudinal stretching. - **Steel vs Rubber:** In everyday language, people think rubber is more elastic because it stretches easily. But scientifically, **Elasticity is the property by virtue of which a body resists deformation and restores its original shape**. Since steel requires an enormous stress to produce even a minute strain ($Y_{ ext{steel}} \gg Y_{ ext{rubber}}$), **Steel is far more elastic than rubber**! - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Common UPPSC science question: "Which is more elastic: Steel or Rubber?" The scientific answer is unequivocally **STEEL**!

Question 288

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Expressways Network of Uttar Pradesh

Match List-I (Expressway in UP) with List-II (Terminating Districts / Alignment) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Expressway) A. Yamuna Expressway
B. Purvanchal Expressway
C. Bundelkhand Expressway
D. Ganga Expressway

List-II (Alignment / Terminating Districts) 1. Greater Noida to Agra (165 km)
2. Meerut to Prayagraj (594 km)
3. Bharatkoop (Chitrakoot) to Kudrail (Etawah) (296 km)
4. Chand Sarai (Lucknow) to Haidaria (Ghazipur) (341 km)

Options: A. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2
B. A-4, B-1, C-3, D-2
C. A-1, B-3, C-4, D-2
D. A-2, B-4, C-3, D-1

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **Yamuna Expressway:** 165 km, 6-lane access-controlled expressway connecting **Greater Noida to Agra**. - **Purvanchal Expressway:** 341 km, connects **Lucknow to Ghazipur** via Barabanki, Amethi, Sultanpur, Ayodhya, Ambedkar Nagar, Azamgarh, and Mau; features an emergency airstrip at Kurebhar (Sultanpur). - **Bundelkhand Expressway:** 296 km, connects **Chitrakoot to Etawah** (linking with Agra-Lucknow Expressway) via Banda, Mahoba, Hamirpur, Jalaun, and Auraiya. - **Ganga Expressway:** 594 km mega-expressway connecting **Meerut (Bijauli) to Prayagraj (Judapur Dandu)** across 12 districts along the Ganges. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Uttar Pradesh is known as the "Expressway Capital of India" with the largest operational and under-construction expressway network in the country!

Question 289

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Plastic Waste Management Rules & EPR

Consider the following statements regarding plastic waste management in India: 1. The nationwide ban on the manufacture, import, stocking, distribution, sale, and use of identified Single-Use Plastic (SUP) items came into effect on July 1, 2022. 2. The minimum permissible thickness of plastic carry bags was mandated at 120 microns with effect from December 31, 2022. 3. Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) mandates producers, importers, and brand owners (PIBOs) to collect and recycle the plastic packaging they introduce into the market.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Single-Use Plastic Ban:** Effective July 1, 2022, under the Plastic Waste Management Amendment Rules, banning 19 low-utility, high-littering SUP items (plastic earbuds, balloon sticks, candy sticks, thermocol plates, cups, cutlery, wrapping films). - **Thickness Standards:** Raised to 75 microns in September 2021, and further to **120 microns** from December 31, 2022 (to promote reuse and facilitate mechanical recycling). - **EPR Framework:** Legally binding targets under 4 categories (Rigid, Flexible single-layer, Multilayered, Compostable plastic); overseen via centralized CPCB online portal. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Oxo-degradable plastics are NOT eco-friendly; they are banned because they fragment into persistent microplastics!

Question 290

Subject: Indian Economy & Demographics | **Topic:** Census 2011 Child Sex Ratio

Consider the following statements regarding the Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years) in Census 2011: 1. India's overall Child Sex Ratio declined from 927 in 2001 to 919 in 2011. 2. Arunachal Pradesh recorded the highest Child Sex Ratio among all Indian states (972 girls per 1,000 boys). 3. Haryana recorded the lowest Child Sex Ratio among all Indian states (834 girls per 1,000 boys).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **National Figure:** 919 girls per 1,000 boys (lowest since independence; dropped by 8 points from 927 in 2001). - **State Highest: Arunachal Pradesh (972)**, followed by Mizoram (970) and Meghalaya (970). - **State Lowest: Haryana (834)**, followed by Punjab (846) and Jammu & Kashmir (862). - **UT Highest:** Andaman & Nicobar Islands (968). - **UT Lowest:** Delhi (871) and Chandigarh (880). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In Overall Sex Ratio, Kerala is highest (1084); but in **Child Sex Ratio (0–6 years), Arunachal Pradesh is highest (972)**!

Question 291

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922)

Consider the following statements regarding the Non-Cooperation Movement: 1. The resolution for Non-Cooperation was initially approved at the Special Calcutta Session in September 1920, and formally ratified at the Nagpur Session in December 1920. 2. At the Nagpur Session, C.R. Das moved the main resolution on Non-Cooperation. 3. Mahatma Gandhi abruptly suspended the movement on February 12, 1922, following the Chauri Chaura incident in Gorakhpur district.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Calcutta Special Session (Sept 1920):** Presided by Lala Lajpat Rai; Gandhi's non-cooperation program passed despite initial hesitation of C.R. Das and B.C. Pal. - **Nagpur Session (Dec 1920):** Presided by C. Vijayaraghavachariar; historic reconciliation where **C.R. Das himself moved the main non-cooperation resolution**; Congress goal changed to attainment of *Swaraj* through peaceful and legitimate means. - **Chauri Chaura Incident (4 February 1922):** An angry peasant mob surrounded and set ablaze the police station in Chauri Chaura (Gorakhpur, UP), burning 22 policemen alive. Gandhi withdrew the movement at the Congress Working Committee meeting at Bardoli on **February 12, 1922** (*Bardoli Resolution*). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** UP government officially corrected the historical date of the Chauri Chaura incident to **February 4, 1922** (earlier written as Feb 5)!

Question 292

Subject: Ancient Indian History | **Topic:** Sequence of Foreign Invasions in Ancient India

Arrange the following foreign invaders of ancient India in chronological order: 1. Indo-Greeks (Bactrian Greeks) 2. Alexander the Great (Macedonian) 3. Kushans 4. Sakas (Scythians)

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 1 — 4 — 3
B. 1 — 2 — 4 — 3
C. 2 — 4 — 1 — 3
D. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Chronological ladder of ancient foreign incursions: 1. **Persian Invasions (c. 518 BCE):** Achaemenid Emperor Darius I conquered Punjab/Sindh. 2. **Alexander the Great (326 BCE):** Crossed the Indus; fought Porus at the Battle of the Hydaspes (Jhelum). 3. **Indo-Greeks (c. 180 BCE):** First to issue gold coins bearing portrait heads and bilingual legends; King Menander (Milinda). 4. **Sakas / Scythians (c. 1st Century BCE):** Replaced Greeks; established five branches (Taxila, Mathura, Ujjain/Western Kshatrapas); King Rudradaman I. 5. **Parthians / Pahlavas (c. 1st Century CE):** King Gondophares (visited by St. Thomas). 6. **Kushans (c. 1st Century CE):** Yuezhi nomads; Kujula Kadphises -> Vima Kadphises -> Kanishka I (78 CE Saka Era). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Sequence mnemonic: **G-S-P-K** (Greeks -> Sakas -> Parthians -> Kushans)!

Question 293

Subject: Geography of India | **Topic:** River Islands & Drainage Features

Consider the following statements regarding Majuli Island: 1. Majuli is a large riverine island located in the Brahmaputra River in Assam. 2. It is recognized as the world's largest inhabited river island by Guinness World Records. 3. In 2016, Majuli became the first island district created in India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Formation:** Formed by the Brahmaputra river to the south and the Kherkutia Xuti (an anabranch joined by Subansiri river) to the north. - **Cultural Hub:** Epicenter of Assamese Neo-Vaishnavite culture established by saint **Srimanta Sankardeva**; houses numerous historic *Satras* (monasteries). - **Administrative Milestone:** Carved out of Jorhat district in September 2016 to become **India's first river island district**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Srirangapatna, Shivanasamudra, and Srirangam are three famous riverine islands formed by the **Kaveri River**!

Question 294

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** Office and Powers of the Lok Sabha Speaker

Consider the following statements regarding the Speaker of the Lok Sabha: 1. The Speaker is elected by the Lok Sabha from amongst its members under Article 93. 2. The Speaker does not vote in the first instance, but exercises a casting vote in the case of an equality of votes under Article 100(1). 3. Under Article 110(3), the decision of the Speaker as to whether a Bill is a Money Bill or not is final. 4. When the Lok Sabha is dissolved, the Speaker immediately vacates his office.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1, 2 and 3 only
B. 1, 3 and 4 only
C. 2, 3 and 4 only
D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Statements 1, 2, and 3 are correct: Speaker conducts business; votes ONLY in case of a tie (*Casting Vote* under Article 100); certification of Money Bills is final and non-challengeable in ordinary course; presides over Joint Sittings (Article 108). - Statement 4 is incorrect: Under the second proviso to **Article 94**, whenever the Lok Sabha is dissolved, **the Speaker DOES NOT vacate his office immediately**! The Speaker remains in office until immediately before the first meeting of the newly elected Lok Sabha. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The Speaker submits his resignation letter to the **Deputy Speaker** of the Lok Sabha (NOT to the President)!

Question 295

Subject: General Science (Biology) | **Topic:** Blood Coagulation Mechanism

Arrange the sequential biochemical events involved in blood clotting (hemostasis) in chronological order: 1. Conversion of soluble Fibrinogen into insoluble Fibrin mesh by Thrombin 2. Release of Thromboplastin from injured tissues and activated platelets 3. Conversion of inactive Prothrombin into active Thrombin in the presence of Calcium ions (Ca^{2+}) and Thrombokinase 4. Entanglement of blood cells in the fibrin network forming a stable clot

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options: A. 2 — 3 — 1 — 4
B. 3 — 2 — 1 — 4
C. 2 — 1 — 3 — 4
D. 1 — 2 — 3 — 4

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Enzyme cascade mechanism of blood clotting: 1. Injured tissues and lysed platelets release **Thromboplastin / Thrombokinase**. 2. Thrombokinase, in the presence of **Calcium (Ca^{2+})** ions, catalyzes the conversion of inactive plasma protein **Prothrombin into active Thrombin**. 3. Thrombin then enzymatically converts soluble **Fibrinogen into insoluble thread-like Fibrin** monomers. 4. Fibrin threads polymerize into a dense network trapping red blood cells and platelets, forming a **coagulum / clot**. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point: Calcium ions (Ca^{2+})** are essential for blood clotting (Factor IV). Heparin is the natural anticoagulant produced by liver/basophils that prevents clotting inside intact blood vessels!

Question 296

Subject: Uttar Pradesh Special | **Topic:** Premier Universities of Uttar Pradesh

Match List-I (Historic University in UP) with List-II (Year of Establishment & Founder) and select the correct answer:

List-I (University) A. Banaras Hindu University (BHU)
B. Aligarh Muslim University (AMU)
C. University of Allahabad
D. Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University (BBAU)

List-II (Year & Key Association) 1. Established 1887; fourth oldest university in India ("Oxford of the East")
2. Established 1916 by Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya; Central University
3. Established 1996 in Lucknow; Central University dedicated to Babasaheb Ambedkar
4. Established 1920 (evolved from MAO College founded 1875 by Sir Syed Ahmad Khan)

Options: A. A-2, B-4, C-1, D-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3
C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3
D. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - **BHU (Varanasi, 1916):** Founded by Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya and Dr. Annie Besant (evolved from Central Hindu College 1898); established under the BHU Act, 1915. - **AMU (Aligarh, 1920):** Founded as Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental (MAO) College in 1875 by Sir Syed Ahmad Khan; elevated to university status in 1920. - **University of Allahabad (1887):** Founded in September 1887; 4th oldest university in modern India; nicknamed "Oxford of the East" for producing civil servants. - **BBAU (Lucknow, 1996):** Central University in Lucknow. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** The oldest university in Uttar Pradesh is the **University of Allahabad (1887)**!

Question 297

Subject: Environment & Ecology | **Topic:** Population Ecology & Carrying Capacity

Consider the following statements regarding population growth models: 1. In the exponential growth model (J-shaped curve), population grows unchecked when resources (food and space) are unlimited ($dN/dt = rN$). 2. In the logistic growth model (Verhulst-Pearl Logistic curve), population growth levels off as it approaches the Carrying Capacity (K), forming an S-shaped (sigmoid) curve. 3. The logistic growth rate is represented by the differential equation: $\frac{dN}{dt} = rN \left(\frac{K - N}{K} \right)$.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three statements are correct: - **Exponential Growth (J-curve):** Occurs in unrealistic conditions of infinite resources; growth accelerates indefinitely until crash. - **Verhulst-Pearl Logistic Growth (Sigmoid / S-curve):** Realistic model representing natural ecosystems where resources are finite; exhibits: - *Lag phase* (initial slow adaptation). - *Log / Exponential phase* (rapid acceleration). - *Deceleration phase* (environmental resistance increases). - *Asymptote* (population reaches stationary equilibrium at **Carrying Capacity K**). - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** When $N = K$ (population size equals carrying capacity), $\frac{K - N}{K} = 0$, meaning population growth rate $\frac{dN}{dt}$ drops to **ZERO**!

Question 298

Subject: Indian Economy | **Topic:** Revised MSME Classification Criteria (2020)

Match List-I (MSME Enterprise Category) with List-II (Composite Criteria: Investment & Annual Turnover) and select the correct answer:

List-I (Enterprise) A. Micro Enterprise
B. Small Enterprise
C. Medium Enterprise

List-II (Investment in Plant & Machinery AND Turnover Limits) 1. Investment $\le ext{₹10 Crore}$ AND Annual Turnover $\le ext{₹50 Crore}$
2. Investment $\le ext{₹1 Crore}$ AND Annual Turnover $\le ext{₹5 Crore}$
3. Investment $\le ext{₹50 Crore}$ AND Annual Turnover $\le ext{₹250 Crore}$

Options: A. A-2, B-1, C-3
B. A-1, B-2, C-3
C. A-2, B-3, C-1
D. A-3, B-1, C-2

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - Effective July 1, 2020 (under Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan), the distinction between manufacturing and services was abolished, adopting a **composite criterion of Investment and Turnover**: - **Micro:** Investment $\le ₹1 ext{ Crore}$ AND Turnover $\le ₹5 ext{ Crore}$ (1:5 ratio). - **Small:** Investment $\le ₹10 ext{ Crore}$ AND Turnover $\le ₹50 ext{ Crore}$. - **Medium:** Investment $\le ₹50 ext{ Crore}$ AND Turnover $\le ₹250 ext{ Crore}$. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Export turnover is COMPLETELY EXCLUDED while calculating the annual turnover threshold for all MSMEs!

Question 299

Subject: Current Affairs | **Topic:** 6th National Water Awards (2024)

In the 5th/6th National Water Awards announced by the Ministry of Jal Shakti in 2024, which State was conferred the FIRST prize in the "Best State" category?

Options: A. Odisha
B. Uttar Pradesh
C. Gujarat
D. Madhya Pradesh

Answer: A

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - The Ministry of Jal Shakti announced the 5th National Water Awards in October 2024: - **Best State (1st Prize): Odisha** was awarded the first prize for its pioneering achievements in water conservation, wetland restoration, and urban rainwater harvesting. - **Best State (2nd Prize): Uttar Pradesh** won the second prize. - **Best State (3rd Prize):** Shared jointly by Gujarat and Puducherry. - **Best District (North Zone):** Banda district of Uttar Pradesh won recognition. - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** In the 3rd National Water Awards (2022), Uttar Pradesh had won 1st prize; in 2024, **Odisha won 1st prize** and **UP won 2nd prize**!

Question 300

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Topic:** Cripps Mission (1942) Provisions

Consider the following proposals made by the Cripps Mission in March 1942: 1. Setting up of an Indian Union with Dominion status after the cessation of World War II. 2. Creation of a Constituent Assembly consisting of members partly elected by provincial assemblies through proportional representation and partly nominated by princely states. 3. Any province not willing to accept the new constitution was given the right to frame a separate constitution and form a separate union.

Which of the proposals given above were part of the Cripps Mission offer?

Options: A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation: - **Core Fact & Solution:** - All three proposals were part of the Cripps Offer (March 1942): - **Dominion Status:** Offered after the war with freedom to withdraw from the Commonwealth. - **Constituent Assembly:** Solely Indian body to draft constitution after the war. - **Right to Secede:** The notorious "local option" allowing any province or princely state to opt out and sign a separate treaty with the British Crown (which Congress saw as a blueprint for the balkanization of India). - Mahatma Gandhi famously rejected it as a "*post-dated cheque on a crashing bank*". - **आयोग का Trap / Ratta Point:** Jawaharlal Nehru and Maulana Abul Kalam Azad were the official negotiators appointed by the Congress Working Committee to talk with Sir Stafford Cripps!